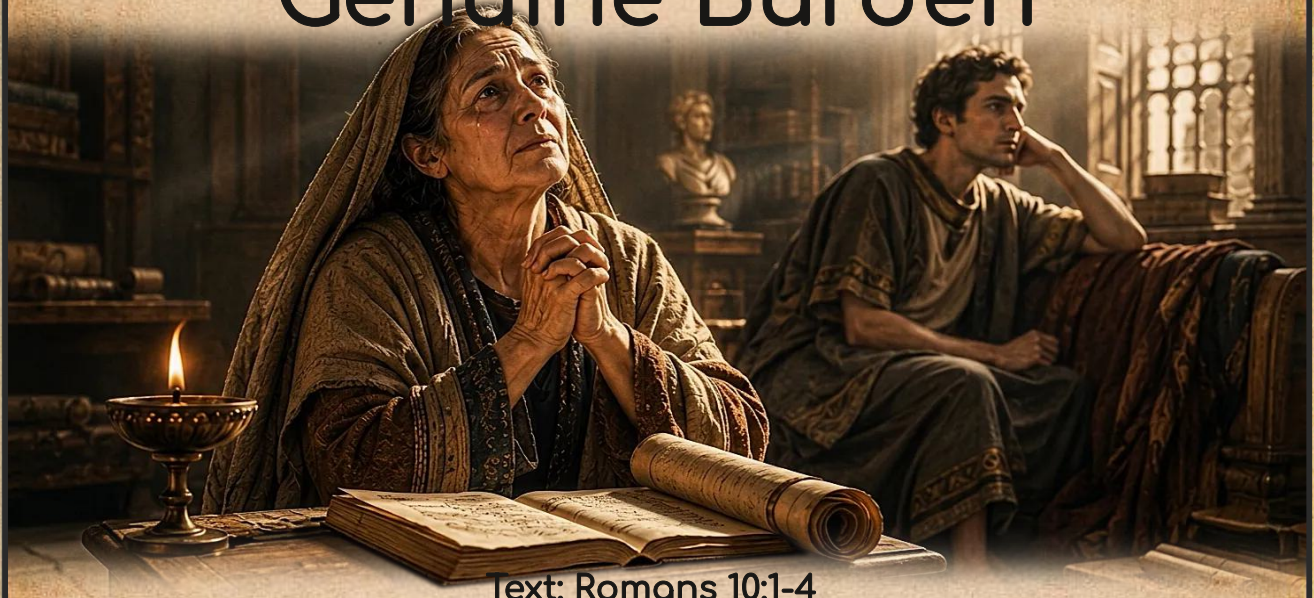
DAILY MANNA

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Wednesday. July 1, 2026

Genuine Burden



Text: Romans 10:1-4

KEY VERSE

"Brethren, my heart's desire and prayer to GOD for Israel is that they might be saved." (Romans 10:1).

Augustine of Hippo, one of Christianity's most influential theologians, lived a wild and dissolute life in his youth. He embraced Manichaeism, a dualistic religion, and lived a life far from God. His mother, Monica, was a devout Christian. For over seventeen years, she unceasingly prayed for his salvation. She followed him, wept over him, and sought out bishops and spiritual leaders to intercede. Wary of her persistence, one bishop finally told her, "Go, your son will be saved; the son of so many tears cannot perish." Monica's burden for her son was so profound that it drove her to relentless prayer and tears. She didn't give up, even when Augustine seemed furthest from God. Her burden for his salvation ultimately led to his dramatic conversion, a testament to the power of a heart burdened in prayer.

Before the 4th century, when the prayer and burden of Augustine's mother eventually led to his conversion, Paul the apostle had shown us what it means to demonstrate that heartfelt desire and burden for the salvation of our people. The fervour was unmistakable, his zeal knew no bounds, and his passion was infectious. Israel's lack of understanding led them to establish their own standards of righteousness and remain in darkness. Israel was doubtlessly religious but ignorant of God's provision for salvation. Yet, Paul the apostle never gave up on them. Today, many still demonstrate zeal for God without true knowledge, which leads to a futile pursuit of righteousness.

As believers, our passion should align with Paul's—praying fervently and working tirelessly to save those still wallowing in self-righteousness. We must share the gospel with love, guiding seekers, including our relatives and fellow citizens, away from the path of destruction. We must lovingly point them to Christ, the Saviour of the world. Do not write them off. The provision of Christ on the cross at Calvary is also available for their redemption today. Supplicate, intercede, and go after them with genuine concern and love; the Lord will have mercy on them. The time to start is now.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

Burden begets salvation breakthroughs

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

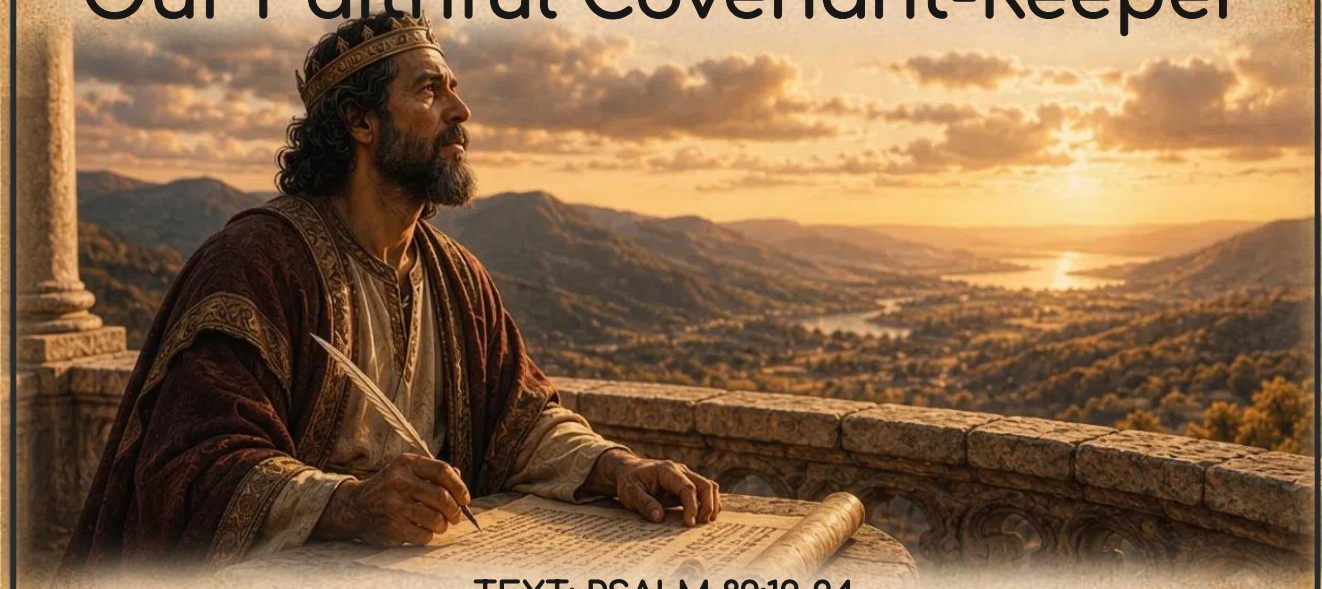
Genesis 1-3

DAILY MANNA

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Thursday. July 2, 2026

Our Faithful Covenant-Keeper



TEXT: PSALM 89:19-24

KEY VERSE

"The enemy shall not exact upon him; nor the son of wickedness afflict him. And I will beat down his foes before his face, and plague them that hate him" (Psalm 89:22,23).

You might have heard the saying, "Promises are meant to be broken," especially in the business world. Sadly, this often proves true today, as people quickly make and break commitments at will. Even marriage, which is supposed to be the most sacred bond, isn't immune to this trend of infidelity. People might agree to terms on paper, but when it becomes inconvenient, they back out or end relationships at the first sign of trouble. God is different. When He makes a promise, He keeps it.

The passage under consideration brings us back to God's unwavering covenant with David. Ethan, the inspired writer of this psalm, reflects on the significant moment when the prophet Samuel anointed David to be the future king of Israel. This anointing was more than just a ritual; it represented God's choice and empowerment for leadership. The psalmist starts by recalling God's promise to David and his descendants, ensuring that David's dynasty would last forever. He describes the blessings that come with this promise: David would have divine support in ruling his kingdom; his people would be free from oppression, and his enemies—both external and within— would be swiftly defeated or struck down by plague. David would experience God's faithfulness and mercy, which would benefit his subjects and clear the way for his kingdom's growth. His "horn," a symbol of his power, would be lifted high as God fights his battles, granting him victory and security.

As we reflect on this passage, we are reminded that God's promises are grounded in His faithfulness, not in our abilities or worthiness. David's anointing and the promise to his dynasty are a testament to God's sovereign choice and empowerment. In our own lives, we can find encouragement in God's faithfulness. Just as David's throne was secure because of God's promise, we too, will find safety when we build our lives on God, the ultimate covenant Keeper. There was a time when Israel strayed from God, and David's dynasty faced defeat in battle. Then, it seemed like God's promise to him would fail. Ultimately, the covenant was fulfilled through Jesus Christ, the Son of David, who will reign forever. Though men fail, God's faithfulness never fails!

Today, believers partake of God's promises through faith in Jesus. In case you are searching for a love that never fails, it can only be found in a relationship with the covenant-keeping God.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

Faith in God's faithfulness is vital in our walk with Him

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

Genesis 4-6

DAILY MANNA

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Friday. July 3, 2026

Unravelling a Mystery



TEXT: Ephesians 3:1-7

KEY VERSE

"How that by revelation he made known unto me the mystery; (as I wrote afore in few words" (Ephesians 3:3).

There are many diseases that doctors know very little or nothing about. They are mysteries. One of such mysterious diseases is "the mysterious epidemic that swept the world from 1917 to 1928. Half a million people were afflicted with a ghastly condition that could be part of the plot line of a horror film. The victims—very much alive and conscious—found themselves in inexplicably frozen states. This sickness first appeared in Europe and quickly spread around the world, reaching epidemic levels in North America, Europe, and India by 1919. About a third of those stricken with the illness, died. Of the survivors, nearly half eventually found themselves unable to interact physically with the world around them, all the while fully aware of their surroundings.

From today's text, Paul begins to speak of the great 'mystery' that was the central calling of his life. But it wasn't a 'mystery' in the sense that people typically think. This is not a 'mystery' that any human being can figure out and solve by good detective or guesswork. Rather, a 'mystery'—as the word is being used in the New Testament—is an aspect of God's redemptive plan for humanity that is known only to Him, revealed in due time by Him to humankind. This is something that is only known by God, but graciously, He allowed it to be revealed to Paul the apostle in due time. "That the Gentiles should be fellow heirs, and of the same body, and partakers of his promise in Christ by the gospel." This became the nucleolus of Paul's ministry to the Gentiles.

Consequently, Paul the apostle needed to convince his Jewish brethren that it was God's will that the gospel message of salvation be taken to the Gentiles and indeed the world. But the Jewish religious hardliners, who were patently engrossed in the doctrine of Jewish exclusive right to salvation, would not understand. His fellow citizens became an albatross to his missionary work in the old Roman Empire and Asia Minor, where he undertook several missionary journeys.

When it comes to delivering a God-revealed mystery to sinful humanity, it can't be done in human power. Paul was, of course, unique — and he was uniquely suited by God's providence to minister this mystery in such a pioneering and authoritative way. However, he saw it as a mystery of which he became a minister according to the gift of the grace of God given to him by the effective working of His power (Ephesians 3:7). God has one mystery that we all should be aware of - that salvation is not only for an exclusive or predetermined set of people. We need to take the same message to everyone in the world because Christ died for the whole world.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

The reality of our salvation proves the veracity of divine revelation.

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

Genesis 7-10

DAILY MANNA

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Saturday. July 4, 2026

Lot of The Foolish



Text: Proverbs 12:14-20

KEY VERSE

"The way of a fool is right in his own eyes: but he that hearkeneth unto counsel is wise" (Proverbs 12:15).

A man who was hard-of-hearing was in the company of new acquaintances. One of the people entertained them with a funny story that sent everyone laughing. They observed that the man was not tickled by the story and suspected that he had a hearing impairment. When he realised what was happening, he belittled the story that caused the laughter, and told them he had a funnier story. They listened to him repeat the same story that had been told earlier. This confirmed the people's suspicion, and as they laughed at his blunder, he interjected, "Didn't I tell you I'd tell a funnier story that would cause you more laughter?"

The unwarranted pretence of the hard-of-hearing man is akin to the self-conceit of a fool. Today's text highlights some of the traits of a foolish person and their bitter consequences. Many things are associated with foolishness, but the worst is that the fool's way is right in his own eyes. By this, he prevents himself from ever getting wise. Foolery spares no aspect of the fool's life. He speaks indiscreetly, walks loftily, acts sinfully, and thinks deceitfully and vainly. He brings upon himself unimaginable misery here and hereafter. Conversely, the wise treads cautiously and righteously and experiences true fulfilment, peace, and joy now and in eternity.

Someone is not a fool because of an occasional decision or choice. Sometimes, we make such mistakes. The Bible says, "The fool hath said in his heart, There is no God." A fool is, therefore, a person who disregards God; a practical atheist who acts as if there is no God. This disposition is at the root of all the deviant behaviours and wicked practices around us. The grim consequences of this indiscretion are too glaring to ignore – premature death, preventable diseases, unfulfilled careers, miserable living, and dishonour, to mention a few.

God invites you to savour His wisdom and the associated truth and righteousness, which result in satisfaction, peace, joy, and fulfilment. True wisdom is not gained from intellectual or academic exertion or exposure through travel and interactions. "The fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom" (Proverbs 9:10). Rudimentary knowledge of God is not enough. The more you understand God's word, the wiser you become.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

Recovery from foolishness starts when a fool realises his foolishness.

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

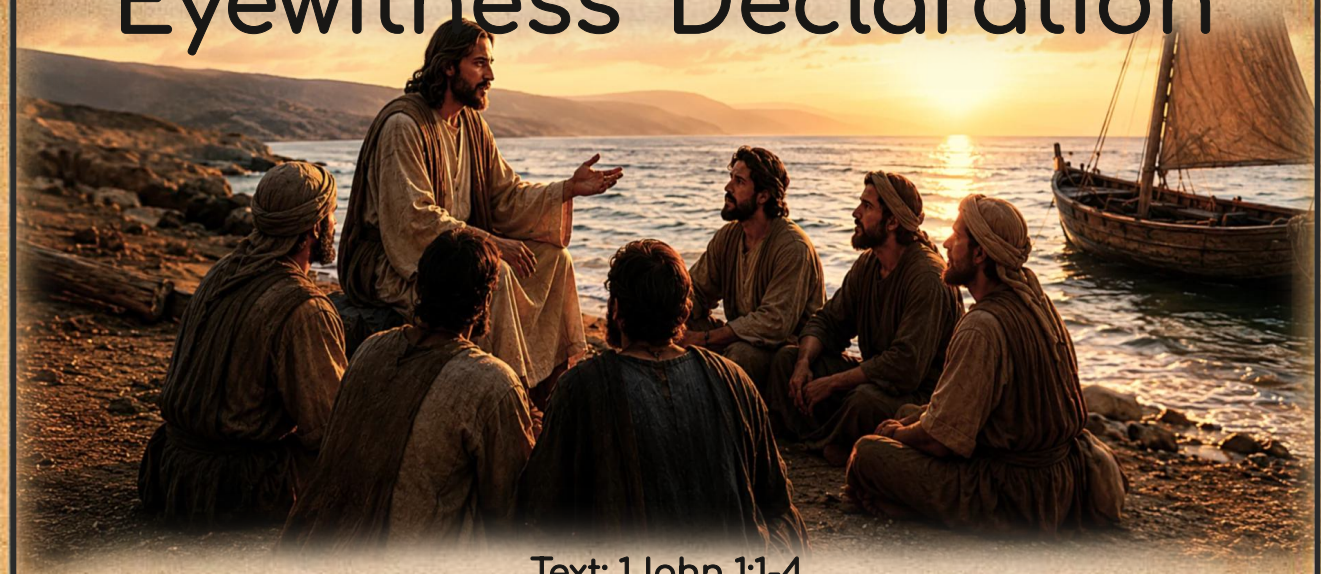
Genesis 11-13

DAILY MANNA

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Sunday. July 5, 2026

Eyewitness' Declaration



Text: 1John 1:1-4

KEY VERSE

"That which was from the beginning, which we have heard, which we have seen with our eyes, which we have looked upon, and our hands have handled, of the Word of life" (1 John 1:1).

The accounts of eyewitnesses are usually reliable and often more factual than handed down tales or even recycled stories that carry exaggerated details.

The writer of this epistle, John the beloved, squares up and writes authoritatively in a manner akin to incorruptible judges who dispassionately weigh all the evidences of the two sides (plaintiff and defendant) and come up with incontestable verdicts that render all falsehood crashing and cascading like a pack of cards. Such verdicts are informed by the knowledge or intimacy with the facts surrounding the contestation. Based on first-hand and intimate relationship with Christ, John encapsulates his knowledge in four crisp verses. Here, he portrays a picturesque attestation of first, the dateless existence of Christ; second, the treasure of Christ's presence; third, the eternal and abundant life in Christ with its attendant resplendence; and finally, the humanity of Christ.

Knowledge anchors the Christian's faith in the Rock of ages. Chuck Swindoll, the American nonagenarian pastor and theologian sums up the importance of knowledge exquisitely: "First, knowledge gives substance to faith. Second, knowledge stabilises us during times of testing. Third, knowledge enables us to handle the word of God accurately. Similarly, knowledge equips us to detect and confront error. Furthermore, knowledge makes us confident and consistent in our walk with God. Knowledge filters out our fears and superstitions."

The purposes set out in this epistle is noble. The first is to enhance and enrich the fellowship of saints. The second is to fill the hearts of believers with joy. Significantly, every believer must seek and make the best of the knowledge of the Person, power and presence of Christ. It is in His presence that we have fellowship one with another. Christian fellowship is two-dimensional. We must know the reality of fellowship with the Father and with His Son Jesus Christ before we can know the reality of fellowship with each other in our common relationship to God. The person who is not in fellowship with the Father and the Son is no Christian at all, and so, cannot share with Christians, the realities of their fellowship.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

The more we know the Lord, the better we can deal with men and moments.

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

Genesis 14-16

DAILY MANNA

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Monday. July 6, 2026

Blessings for Obedience



Text: Deuteronomy 28:1-4

KEY VERSE

"And all people of the earth shall see that thou art called by the name of the LORD; and they shall be afraid of thee" (Deuteronomy 28:10).

The blessings of God often come with conditions. This is reflected in today's text. Although God adopted Israel as His chosen people, there were certain standards of behaviour, compliance and worship that would confer the blessings on them. By obeying, they would remain in a right relationship with Him, receive His blessing, and bring glory to His name.

That was the purpose of God for His people. Its fulfilment was conditional upon their obedience. They were to observe strict alignment with the Lord who redeemed them from the tyrannical grip of Egypt: "...if thou shalt hearken diligently unto the voice of the LORD thy God, to observe and to do all his commandments..." Having made this general declaration, Moses proceeded to describe the blessings, which would follow obedience. In the light of the subsequent history of these people, we see how literally all these things were fulfilled. How solemn and searching this old-time story is for us!

In Christ, the law as given to Moses is done away with, because He has given us a higher law, which far transcends the former in standard and purity. In reality however, the principles remain. Obedience still results in blessings. It is still when we hearken diligently unto the voice of God, to observe to do His commandments, that we are blessed above all the nations and people of the earth.

With us, also, as with the people of Israel, the divine intention of our exaltation is not that we should act like tyrants over the brethren, people or neighbours around us, and hold them in contempt; but that we should serve them, and lead them into the blessings of redemption and justification.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

Unqualified obedience brings unparalleled blessings

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

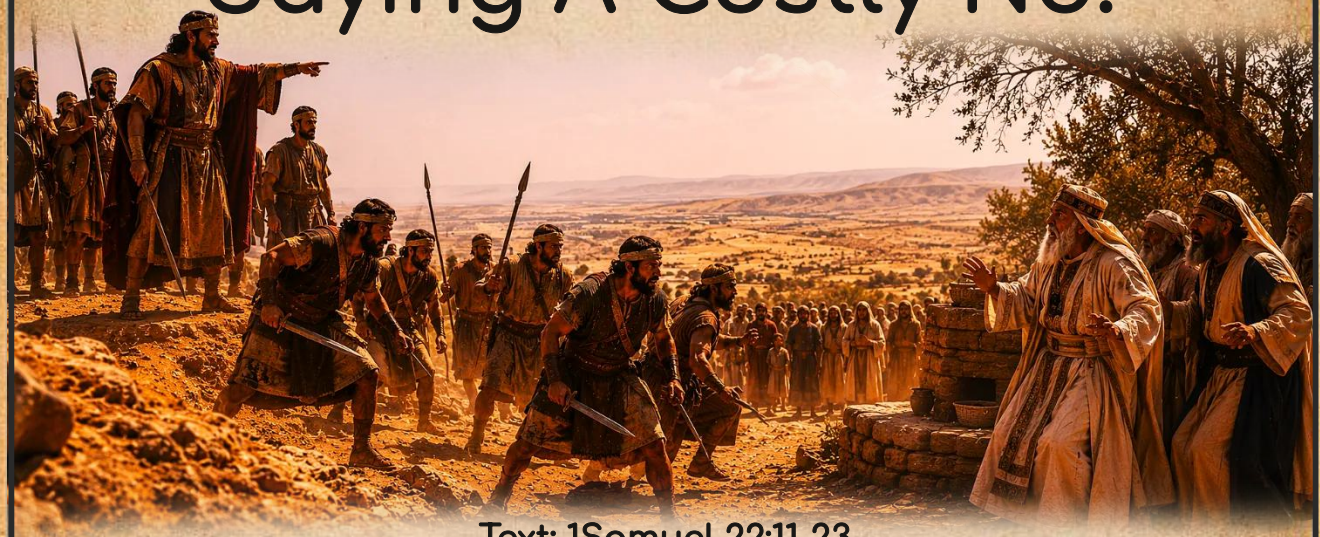
Genesis 17-20

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Tuesday. July 7, 2026

Saying A Costly No!



Text: 1Samuel 22:11-23

KEY VERSE

"And the king said unto the footmen that stood about him, Turn, and slay the priests of the LORD; because their hand also is with David, and because they knew when he fled, and did not shew it to me. But the servants of the king would not put forth their hand to fall upon the priests the LORD..." (1 Samuel 22:17).

History is replete with accounts of men and women who had to say no even when they knew it would cost them a great deal. German pastor and theologian Dietrich Bonhoeffer is one of such. Based on his faith and moral conviction, he dared to say no to Adolf Hitler's regime and the compromising "German Church." In the 1930s-1940s, he openly opposed Nazi ideology and helped form the Confessing Church. He was eventually arrested and executed, but his stand remains a symbol of Christian courage.

The footmen who worked with King Saul in his evil hunt for David's life dared to disobey the command of the king to kill Ahimelech, the priest of the Lord, for his supposed support for David. They could not bring themselves to partake in such injustice, cruelty, and ungodliness. Not many Bible readers have considered the bravery of these soldiers. To disobey a wicked King Saul was risky enough. But to disobey an outraged King Saul in such a circumstance amounted to a suicide bid. What became of them is not recorded, but these soldiers have earned a name among the 'greats'. They would rather obey the voice of their conscience than obey an evil command.

As for Saul, his malice against David made him lose his mind, and so blinded him that he suspected anyone who did not openly support his misguided mission. Neither Ahimelech's plea of innocence nor his servants' caution could restrain him from his murderous resolve. It took a sycophantic and malicious Doeg, an Edomite overseer of Saul's flocks, to carry out Saul's execution of not only Ahimelech and eighty four other priests, but also a whole town of Nob.

As Christians living in a world full of contradictions and moral depravity, we often run into circumstances that demand we take a stand for the Lord. Here, many succumb to the popular options that hold little or no suffering and ridicule. But they become the real losers. Those who take their stand and dare to say 'no' to a King Saul on conscientious grounds are the real heroes. Their wages are paid in the currency of time and eternity. Will you dare for the Lord?

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

When saying no to man means saying yes to God, say yes!

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

Genesis 21-23

DAILY MANNA

dailymanna.app

Wednesday. July 8, 2026

Power of Attorney



Text: John 14:12-15

KEY VERSE

"Verily, verily, I say unto you, He that believeth on me, the works that I do shall he do also; and greater works than these shall he do; because I go unto my Father" (John 14:12).

Reverend K. E. Hagin (1917 – 2003), an American gospel minister, is known for pioneering the Word of Faith movement, following E. W. Kenyon's footsteps. He recognises believers' position and authority when he says, "As believers, we have been given the power of attorney to act on behalf of Jesus Christ." Little wonder his classics and messages on faith have become so popular among believers globally. In his lifetime, he deployed that delegated power of faith to do exploits in the church. His legacy has continued to inspire many believers who draw insights and inspirations from his books and messages.

In our text, Jesus, our Lord and Redeemer, bequeaths His disciples with the authority and power to do what He would have done if He were still on the earth. The believer in Christ is a new creature and has been stripped of the sinful, weak, fearful, and powerless nature, which is replaced with the divine nature. He is not timid but bold because he has the spirit of love (that casts out fear), power, and a sound mind. He has been given the power of attorney.

This is the legal right given by a person to another to act on his behalf. It is an agent or attorney-in-fact's legal authorisation to act on behalf of his principal.

Prayers in the name of Jesus guarantee undeniable answers because they imply that Christ is praying for us. The Father never denies the Son any request. Believers are heirs of God and are joint-heirs with Christ. We must always approach the throne of grace with absolute confidence. God hears us always as He did whenever Christ prayed. Besides, our Redeemer lives, ever making intercession for us. Aside using His name in prayers, He also gives us authority to do His work and greater things through His name. Now, every child of God should be involved passionately in the preaching of the gospel, healing the sick, curing the diseased, cleansing lepers, raising the dead, delivering the oppressed, and casting out devils in the name of Jesus.

Until you begin to use what you have, you may not fathom the incredible power and authority at your disposal as a child of God. You are not inferior to other believers. The fact is that they take God at His word and reach out in obedience, and, therefore, see results. If you also go out in faith and do what He says, you will see the glory of God.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

If you've been given the authority to act on Christ's behalf, what are you doing with it?

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

Genesis 24-25

DAILY MANNA

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Thursday. July 9, 2026

Seek Reconciliation



Text: Genesis 33:1-15

KEY VERSE

"Take, I pray thee, my blessing that is brought unto thee; because God hath graciously dealt with me, and because I have enough. And he urged him, and he took it" (Genesis 33:11).

It is inevitable for us to co-exist with others. In so doing, very often, we offend one another. When this happens, we don't hold on to the offences. It is imperative for us, as believers, to reconcile with those who offend us, or those who are hurt by our actions and conducts.

This was what Jacob set out to do as he embarked on the journey home in an imminent tense meeting with his twin brother, Esau. Esau was aggrieved by Jacob for using subterfuge to deprive him of the blessing of their father, Isaac. Fearing the danger of Esau's wrath and his intention to kill him, Jacob had fled home to live with his uncle, Laban. Twenty years later, God appeared to Jacob and instructed him to return to his homeland. He began his homeward journey in obedience to God; but was haunted by the hatred of his brother. He was not sure that many years away from home had healed the wound. Going back home, Jacob must meet his brother with reconciliation, in order to restore their fractured relationship.

Intentionally, Jacob took practical steps toward restoring peace with Esau. Putting his family behind, Jacob went ahead and bowed himself seven times, as he got closer to Esau. This was a gesture of respect, an attempt to pacify his brother and deal with any revengeful thoughts. Additionally, Jacob sent gifts to Esau ahead of their meeting. While Jacob approached his brother with meekness and humility, Esau reciprocated with a hug and a kiss. This was a very refreshing moment! The past wounds had been healed.

As Christians, we are to follow peace with everyone. Where there are offences, let us seek reconciliation and forgiveness. Above all, where there is separation from God and enmity against Him because of sin, there must be reconciliation through repentance and faith in Jesus Christ.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

The sweet fragrance of reconciliation is inestimably soothing.

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

Genesis 26-28

DAILY MANNA

dailymanna.app

Friday. July 10, 2026

Consequences of Trafficking in Idolatry



Text: Isaiah 42:17-25

KEY VERSE

"They shall be turned back, they shall be greatly ashamed, that trust in graven images, that say to the molten images, Ye are our gods" (Isaiah 42:17).

It was the author J.C. Ryle in his book, Practical Religion who says, "Beware of manufacturing a God of your own: a God who is all mercy, but not just; a God who is all love, but not holy; a God who has a heaven for everybody, but a hell for none;... such a God is an idol of your own creation. He is not God of the Bible, and aside from the God of the Bible, there is no God at all." In today's Bible passage, Prophet Isaiah furthered the prophecy concerning the Messiah's kingdom typified by that of Cyrus. It hints at the great success of the gospel and the Church, the defeat of the enemies of the Church and the rejection of the unbelieving and Christ-rejecting Jews. The prophecy particularly points out how those who subscribe to idle worship in the face of all these would be ashamed of their stance.

A call is here given to the spiritually blind and deaf Israel, and by extension professing believers and ministers: "Hear ye deaf; and look, ye blind, that ye may see". Those who would remain obstinate and unbelieving would be allowed to suffer the consequences of their sin. This was the case of Israel who violated God's law and remained misguided even under the correcting rod of God.

Sin has consequence and idolatrous sins have weightier and more lethal consequences. Idolatry is a flagrant affront against the deity of God. He who goes awhoring after any tin god belittles the Almighty as secondary to that which he enthrones in his heart. This act attracts the hot displeasure of God.

If your personality, pursuit, power or possession becomes the primary attraction that distracts you from God, you are digging an abysmal pit for yourself. He who desires to shake off God's wrath should humbly submit his heart to the Lord. Let God be the sole administrator sitting on the throne of your heart. Only then will you savour the blessings of Christ's kingdom.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

Shame belongs to those who disdain the true God

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

Genesis 29-31

DAILY MANNA

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Saturday. July 11, 2026

Treasure through Obedience



Text: Exodus 4:24-31

KEY VERSE

"And the people believed: and when they heard that the LORD had visited the children of Israel, and that he had looked upon their affliction, then they bowed their heads and worshipped" (Exodus 4:31).

In our interconnected world, the call to align with divine purpose resonates deeply within the human spirit. Across diverse cultures and backgrounds, the universal principle remains: true fulfilment emerges from wholehearted obedience to a higher calling. This timeless truth transcends boundaries, inviting each of us to reflect on our commitment to the paths laid before us by the divine.

In the biblical narrative, we find a pivotal moment in Moses' life. After being commissioned by God to lead the Israelites out of bondage, Moses faced a life-threatening situation due to his neglect in circumcising his son—a critical sign of God's covenant with Abraham. It was through the decisive intervention of his wife, Zipporah, that Moses' life was spared, underscoring the profound importance of adhering to divine instructions.

God's favour is intricately linked to our obedience. Moses, despite his unique calling, could not bypass the foundational requirements of the covenant. This serves as a reminder that aspiring to fulfil divine purposes necessitates unwavering commitment to principles of holiness and obedience.

Zipporah's swift and discerning action emphasises the vital role of spiritual awareness within the family unit. Her recognition of the gravity of the situation and prompt response after her initial resistance realigned their household with God's directives. This narrative challenges us to evaluate our own lives and families. Are we attuned to areas requiring spiritual correction? Are we proactive in upholding the covenants we have established with God?

Following this act of obedience, Moses and Aaron came together, demonstrating unity in their mission. They performed the signs God provided, leading the Israelites to believe and respond with worship. This sequence of events illustrates that walking in obedience not only safeguards us but also paves the way for divine manifestations and breakthroughs. When we align our actions with God's will, we create an environment where faith flourishes and God's power is revealed.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

No position is a substitute to obedience, tweak it as you may

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

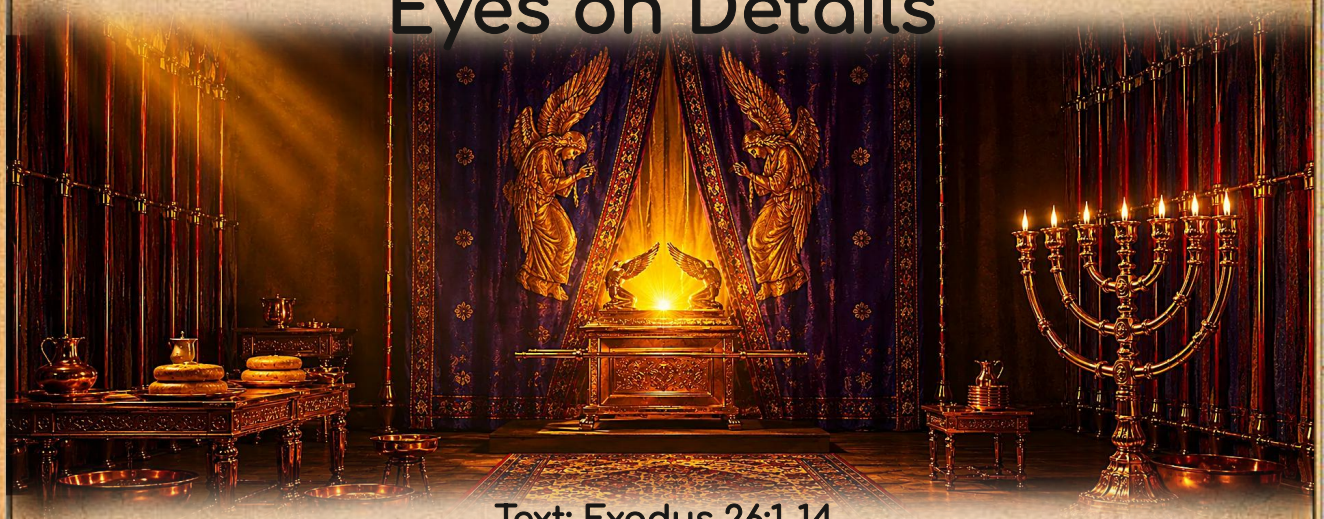
Genesis 32-34

DAILY MANNA

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Sunday. July 12, 2026

Eyes on Details



Text: Exodus 26:1-14

KEY VERSE

"Moreover thou shalt make the tabernacle with ten curtains of fine twined linen, and blue, and purple, and scarlet: with cherubims of cunning work shalt thou make them" (Exodus 26:1).

Sir William Osler was an eminent professor of medicine at Oxford University. In demonstrating his lesson on the necessity of observing details to his eager students, he dipped a finger in a bottle containing urine and then into his mouth. He passed the bottle round and bade the students to do exactly what he did. After each of them in turn had dipped a finger in the bottle and bravely sampled the fluid, the professor announced their failure in observation. They did not observe that he put his index finger into the bottle, but his middle finger into his mouth!

God is a God of details. This is clear in our text where He gave Moses instructions regarding the making of the tabernacle. Observe the minute and accurate description given here concerning both the outer and inner aspects of the tabernacle. The inner part was to comprise ten curtains with specified length, loops and clasps. The outer coverings were to be made of goat's skin, comprising eleven curtains. A cover was also to be made to secure the tabernacle from the weather.

The specifications for the tabernacle emphasised both aesthetics and functionality. The finest materials and colours were prescribed to reflect the glory and majesty of God, whose dwelling place the tabernacle represented. The house of God today should attract no less attention. The tabernacle was to be designed as a movable structure because Israel was still journeying in the wilderness. A permanent temple was built when they eventually settled in their promised land. The curtains were to be embroidered with cherubim – an indication of the angelic ministry to God and His people.

In matters of lifestyle, Christian service and worship, we must not resort to pragmatism and doing things as we see fit or in sync with the popular winds. We must pay attention to detail and ensure we build according to the divine pattern spelt out in God's word. Those who gloss over many things and assure themselves that "it doesn't matter" will eventually discover to their disappointment that God is interested in details.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

Silence is never more golden than when it is God-honouring.

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

Genesis 35-37

DAILY MANNA

dailymanna.app

Monnday. July 13, 2026

Believing the Spies



Text: Joshua 2:1-7

KEY VERSE

"And it was told the king of Jericho, saying, Behold, there came men in hither tonight of the children of Israel to search out the country" (Joshua 2:2).

In his autobiography published in Moscow in 1967, the disgraced former British spy Kim Philby told the story of his life as a double agent for both the British Spy agency M16 and the Soviet KGB. The book recounts how he passed crucial information to the Soviets, compromising Western operations during the Cold War. It provides Philby's own narrative of his motivations, actions and mind-set as a long-term mole until his cover was blown and he escaped to Moscow where he eventually died. Spies live a dangerous life and can put the security of nations and people at risk.

As the new leader for the nation of Israel, Joshua wanted first-hand information about the security and other social conditions in Jericho before launching his attack. For this, he sent two unnamed men to "go view the land". The men went, but unfortunately, their cover was blown almost as soon as they entered the city. They hid in Rahab's house and she, amazingly, cooperated with their covert operations by misdirecting the emissaries of the king of Jericho when they came to her.

The book of Hebrews commended Rahab for her faith in the God of the spies. "By faith the harlot Rahab perished not with them that believed not, when she had received the spies with peace" (Hebrews 11:31). The spies apparently entered Jericho in the evening and not long after, the men of Jericho rightly located where they were. Rahab chose to cast her lot with the two spies and rescue them. This act of faith turned Rahab the harlot to Rahab the forgiven, who became one of the heroines of faith in the Bible.

Each day, we have opportunities to relate with people by faith. You can, like Rahab, believe God's messengers, even when all the prognosis show them as underdogs. You should not ignore the saints and pitch your tent with the king of Jericho because he has the trappings of power on his side. Your choice matters because you are dealing with God's secret agents who may determine your destiny. Be intentional in pitching your tent on GOD's side.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

No one can ever perish trusting the Lord.

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

Genesis 38-40

DAILY MANNA

dailymanna.app

Tuesday. July 14, 2026

When Silence Is Golden



Text: Mark 15:1-5

KEY VERSE

"And the chief priests accused him of many things:
but he answered nothing" (Mark 15:3).

In a letter published in the London Evening News on 8 May 1919, an Australian journalist, Edward George Honey, had proposed a respectful silence to remember those who had given their lives in the First World War. This was brought to the attention of King George V and on 7 November 1919, the king issued a proclamation, which called for a two minute silence. "All locomotion should cease, so that, in perfect stillness, the thoughts of everyone may be concentrated on reverent remembrance of the glorious dead." After the end of the World War II in 1945, Armistice Day became Remembrance Day to include all those who had fallen in the two world wars and other conflicts. Since 1919, on the second Sunday of November, otherwise known as Remembrance Sunday, a two-minute silence has been observed at 11am at war memorials throughout Britain.

Remaining silent is sometimes more valuable than speaking. It suggests that not speaking can be a more effective or beneficial choice than expressing oneself. This is useful, not only to remember the dead, by observing a 'moment of silence', but also to reinforce ourselves while facing life's challenges. Jesus was brought before Pilate by "the elders and scribes and the whole council" bound and humiliated. They wanted Pilate to sentence Him to death. But Jesus chose to keep silent before Pilate, in spite of many baseless accusations levelled against Him. Luke listed some of the allegations they made against Jesus. "And they began to accuse him, saying, We found this fellow perverting the nation, and forbidding to give tribute to Caesar, saying that he himself is Christ a King" (Luke 23:2). His silence surprised all and even Pilate marvelled.

Jesus chose to be silent in fulfilment of the Scriptures. "He was oppressed, and he was afflicted, yet he opened not his mouth..." (Isaiah 53:7). His silence was also in line with the plan and programme of God for His life. It was a choice, and a wise one at that, because He trusted the heavenly Father to perfect everything that concerns Him.

Silence is not a sign of stupidity. It is a sign of power that only highly disciplined people can enjoy. Silence allows spiritual warriors to pick their battles and focus on the essentials. Silence was the weapon God used to overcome at the battle of Jericho. God also told Israel to hold their peace and allow Him to fight for them at the crossing of the Red Sea (Exodus 14:14). Let us always learn to observe moments of silence, as we wait on God, and receive instructions to go forward in difficult times.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

Silence is never more golden than when it is God-honouring.

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

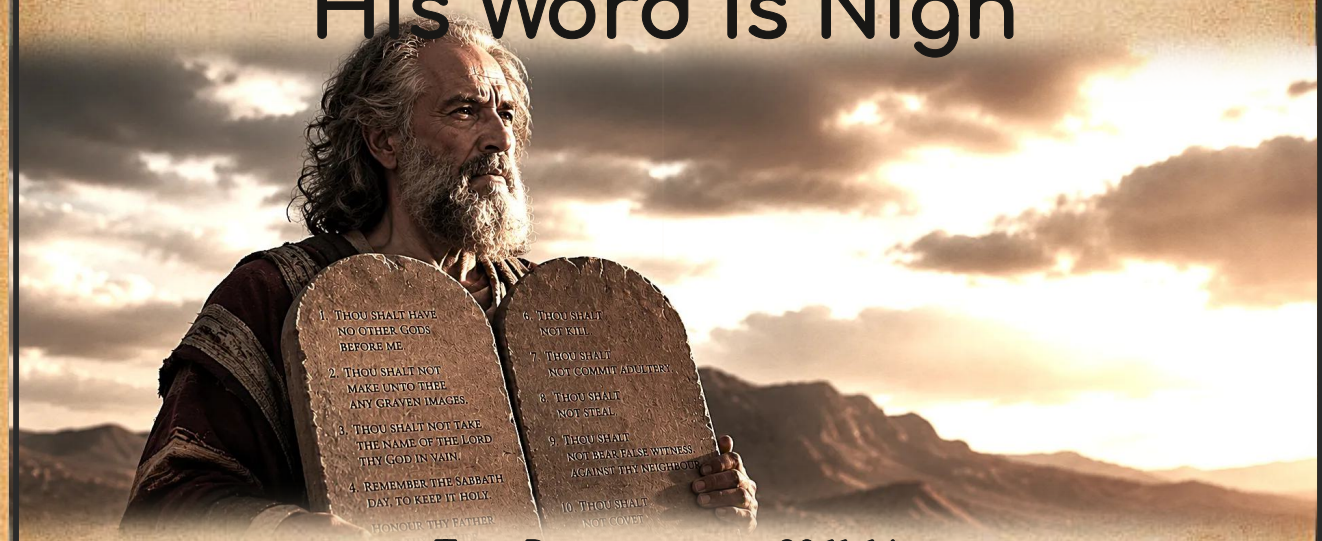
Genesis 41-44

DAILY MANNA

dailymanna.app

Wednesday. July 15, 2026

His Word Is Nigh



Text: Deuteronomy 30:11-14

KEY VERSE

"But the word is very nigh unto thee, in thy mouth, and in thy heart, that thou mayest do it" (Deuteronomy 30:14).

The acclaimed writer, Robert R. Updegraff in his book, Obvious Adams: The Story Of A Successful Business Man, tells the story of Adams, a young man who rises to success in the business world through his ability to see and act on the obvious. Adams has a talent for spotting simple solutions that others overlook. The book reminds us that the most effective solutions are often the simplest, and that by focusing on the fundamentals, we can uncover answers that were hidden in plain sight.

In his last book and as part of his last address to the children of Israel, Moses reminds them of the availability of the word of God as a guide and a set of instructions to practice and live by. God had used Moses to bring the Word to the people through the physical writing of the Ten Commandments on tables of stone. The written Word (Genesis to Deuteronomy) was available for them at that time; they also had access to other compilations of the laws by the scribes as revealed by God to Moses. Everything they needed to know and do to please God had been revealed through Moses, and he had faithfully codified them.

Moses took time to refute the idea that the people needed extra revelation to obey and please God. God's instructions and commandments were comprehensive enough. The instructions were clear and every effort by people to trifle with the word or "search" for it across the sea was unnecessary. The word was near, in their mouth to be spoken and confessed and to be obeyed. He had instructed them earlier, "these words, which I command thee this day, shall be in thine heart" (Deuteronomy 6:6). They were to write the words and "...bind them for a sign upon their hand, and they shall be as frontlets between their eyes" (Deuteronomy 6:8).

Today, the word of God is not just available but also near you. You have it in printed form and it is available in electronic format. You can listen to the audio version or watch it on digital platforms. Whatever medium you may choose, the Word is near to guide and help you to walk in obedience to the instructions of your heavenly Father. Read the Word today and be blessed.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

Having but not acting on the Word is doubly damning.

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

Genesis 45-47

DAILY MANNA

dailymanna.app

Thursday. July 16, 2026

Have Faith in God



Text: John 14:1-4

KEY VERSE

"Let not your heart be troubled: ye believe in God, believe also in me" (John 14:1).

The song, "Have Faith in God", was written by Baylus Benjamin McKinney, (1886-1952). It was composed in 1934 during a revival meeting at the First Baptist Church in Muskogee, Oklahoma at a time that the United States was going through the Great Depression. McKinney was deeply moved by the people's struggles and sufferings and felt a strong desire to offer them a message of hope and encouragement through the song. He wrote, "Have faith in God when your pathway is lonely/He sees and knows all the way you have trod/Never alone are the least of His children/Have faith in God, have faith in God. Have faith in God, He's on His throne/Have faith in God, He watches o'er His own/He cannot fail, He must prevail/Have faith in God, have faith in God."

The ministry of Jesus was nearing its end and in the preceding chapter, the Lord had indicated He was going to leave the disciples. The news of His departure must have jolted them and they must have felt unhappy. Jesus was reassuring them of His continuous presence even when they might not see Him any more physically. He wanted them to believe in God and trust Him at all times. He assured them of His return after going away to prepare a heavenly and eternal home for them.

Believers must heed the words of Jesus and be intentional in developing their faith in God and in His word. Economic hardship and political pressures are changing the situation , forcing the children of God to go through tougher times than ever before. Public ridicule of religion is taking its toll on many believers, causing their love to grow cold. Believers must never lose hope in the word of God and His plans for the end times. We must have confidence in the promises of the Lord Jesus to go and prepare a place of abode for faithful saints.

It takes faith in God to enjoy the blessings He has prepared for His children. We have nothing to lose by putting our confidence in the Lord and we have much more still to gain when we look with hope to His coming again to take us home. In these difficult times, it is more compelling to have faith in God.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

Every believer in Christ holds a double assurance policy - for this life and hereafter.

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

Genesis 48-50

DAILY MANNA

dailymanna.app

Friday. July 17, 2026

Our Peace Offering



Text: Leviticus 3:10-13

KEY VERSE

"And the two kidneys, and the fat that is upon them, which is by the flanks, and the caul above the liver, with the kidneys, it shall he take away. And the priest shall burn it upon the altar: it is the food of the offering made by fire unto the LORD" (Leviticus 3:10,11).

The Hebrew word for "peace" shalom, represents wholeness and right relationship with God, others, and creation. The peace offering, as a voluntary offering, signifies restored relationship with God. This type of offering is indicative of a voluntary expression of faith, thanksgiving, and gratitude.

Our passage today pertains to the detailed instructions given for the peace offerings. These offerings were important for maintaining a harmonious relationship between an individual and God. Specifically, the passage outlines which parts of the animal are to be removed and offered to the Lord. It also gives us the role of the priests in the exercise. The kidneys and the fat signify the best portions of the sacrifice, which were to be dedicated to God. This act of offering the choicest parts is a form of worship and reverence, recognising God's supreme authority and generosity.

From that context, it is clear that such offerings were to be made accurately and respectfully. The focal point of burning these parts was to create a "sweet savour unto the LORD," signifying that the offering was pleasing and acceptable to Him. The prescribed portions for the peace offerings highlight the significance of giving God the best, demonstrating the importance of sacrifice, and dedication in worship.

However while the Old Testament gives us the details of how to make acceptable blood sacrifices, Jesus Christ, in the New Testament, offered up Himself as the Lamb of God who took away our sins on the cross at Calvary. "For he is our peace, who hath made both one, and hath broken down the middle wall of partition between us" (Ephesians 2:14). With Jesus as our peace, we need not kill any animal to make peace for our iniquities, but only embrace Him wholeheartedly. Praise the Lord.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

Any talk about peace that excludes the Prince of Peace is a piece of delusion.

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

Exodus 1-4

DAILY MANNA

dailymanna.app

Saturday. July 18, 2026

Christian Persecution



Text: Acts 8:1-4

KEY VERSE

"And Saul was consenting unto his death. And at that time there was a great persecution against the church which was at Jerusalem; and they were all scattered abroad throughout the regions of Judaea and Samaria, except the apostles" (Acts 8:1).

On its website, Open Doors International, the Christian organisation, published its report on persecution of believers in 2024. The report showed that 4,476 Christians were murdered, 7,679 churches and Christian properties attacked and 4,744 Christians imprisoned across the globe. "In Open Doors' World Watch List top 50 alone, 310 million Christians face very high or extreme levels of persecutions and discriminations for their faith", the report said. Christian persecution is real in our world today.

The early Church also faced persecution as we read from today's Bible passage. The horrible death of Stephen by public stoning in Acts 7 triggered a wave of serious persecutions led by Saul. While the church was mourning over the death of the young preacher, Saul "...made havok of the church, entering into every house, and haling men and women committed them to prison" (Acts 8:3). The believers had no choice but to scatter and flee Jerusalem to safety. The good news though is that the scattering helped them to take the gospel to new locations.

Jesus warned the disciples to prepare for persecution in their journey of faith. He said, "These things have I spoken unto you, that ye should not be offended. They shall put you out of the synagogues: yea, the time cometh, that whosoever killeth you will think that he doeth God service" (John 16:1,2). Persecution is normal in the Christian race, but the grace of God is also available to see us through to the end.

Since we may not be able to avoid persecution, what can we do? We must, like the early Church, develop effective survival strategies. These include prayerfulness, endurance, maintaining a joyful disposition and readiness to spread the gospel anywhere life takes us. We must also raise sound and committed disciples who are ready to labour anywhere and everywhere for the Master.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

Sometimes God uses persecution as a tool for gospel propagation.

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

Exodus 5-7

DAILY MANNA

dailymanna.app

Sunday. July 19, 2026

Just Go!



Text: Exodus 3:16-22

KEY VERSE

"Go, and gather the elders of Israel together, and say unto them, The LORD God of your fathers, the God of Abraham, of Isaac, and of Jacob, appeared unto me, saying, I have surely visited you, and seen that which is done to you in Egypt" (Exodus 3:16).

Gladys Aylward (1902-1970), was a British domestic servant who felt a strong calling to serve as a missionary in China in the 1930s. Gladys felt a conviction to go to China, despite having limited education and resources. She applied to the China Inland Mission (CIM), but they rejected her, deeming her "unsuitable." Undeterred, she saved her own money and, in 1932, embarked on a perilous journey by train across Siberia, for she could not afford travel by sea. She arrived in Yangcheng, China, and worked with an elderly missionary, Jeannie Lawson. After Lawson's death, Gladys took over the mission, becoming known as "Ai-weh-deh" (the virtuous one). She learned the language, adopted Chinese customs, and tirelessly served the local people. Her obedience to God's calling, resulted in her being able to save many lives and influence many people.

Like Gladys, Moses received instructions from God to go to Pharaoh with His message of deliverance of the Israelites. Six times in this short passage, God used the verb "go" to pass instructions to Moses. Humanly speaking, nothing would have made Moses return of his free will to Egypt, because he was a fugitive from justice. But when God's call came, Moses chose to obey.

God gave Moses the blueprint of his assignment in Egypt. He was to first gather the elders of Israel and share the plan of God for their deliverance with them. Along with the leaders, he would approach Pharaoh and deliver the same message. The resistance of Pharaoh would be countered by God's power such that when the Israelites would eventually leave, they would spoil the Egyptians by going with their jewellery and raiment as compensations for their years of servitude.

Just like God sent Moses to Egypt, so He is sending us to the world to share the good news of the cross and deliverance from sin to all and sundry. The assignment is tough and the road may be rough, but God promised to be with us. He was with Moses and other faithful saints of old and He will be with you too today, if you will go and do what He says.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

When God says "go" we need not add a question mark to it.

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

Exodus 8-11

DAILY MANNA

dailymanna.app

Monday. July 20, 2026

Transforming Grace



Text: 1Corinthians 1:26-31

KEY VERSE

"For ye see your calling, brethren, how that not many wise men after the flesh, not many mighty, not many noble, are called" (1 Corinthians 1:26).

In his book Understanding Church Growth, The Christian writer, Donald McGavran, used the phrase "redemption lift" to describe the transformative power of the gospel on people's lives, especially their socioeconomic condition. A more recent work by Rodney Stark, titled, America's Blessings, relying on sociological data, concluded that compared to less religious and nonreligious individuals, people of faith are better off. He believes that a person renewed by the gospel increasingly acts in a self-controlled and selfless manner, engages in less criminal behaviour and experiences higher marital happiness and lower divorce rates, while producing more and better-behaved children.

In today's Bible passage, Apostle Paul believes that the gospel of Christ has positively transformed the lives of the Corinthian Christians. This is because God did not consider the smallness or stature of the Corinthian believers before saving them from the power of sin. Paul reminds the Corinthians of their humble beginning in the journey of faith and how God's transforming grace turned their lives around. God can make giants of anyone no matter his or her poor beginning.

Paul believes that God usually does not apply worldly methods to spiritual things. "God has chosen the foolish things of the world to confound the wise" (1 Corinthians 1:27). The Bible is full of stories of people like the shepherd boy, David, who was brought from obscurity to the throne. Who would have imagined that a man like Zacchaeus would voluntarily surrender his loot to repair the financial damage done to many families? God transforms sinners to saints effortlessly so that no one will claim any credit for the changes in their lives.

The Christian life is a new life where old things do not dictate our progress any more. This is a new life where redemption transforms us from weaklings to giants. The blessedness of knowing Jesus as Lord and Saviour transcends every limitation there might be in our lives, making us into spiritual giants who can effortlessly, gratefully sing, "Amazing Grace"!

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

The amazing thing about Grace is that it admits and transforms the weak, the wordly and the wicked

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

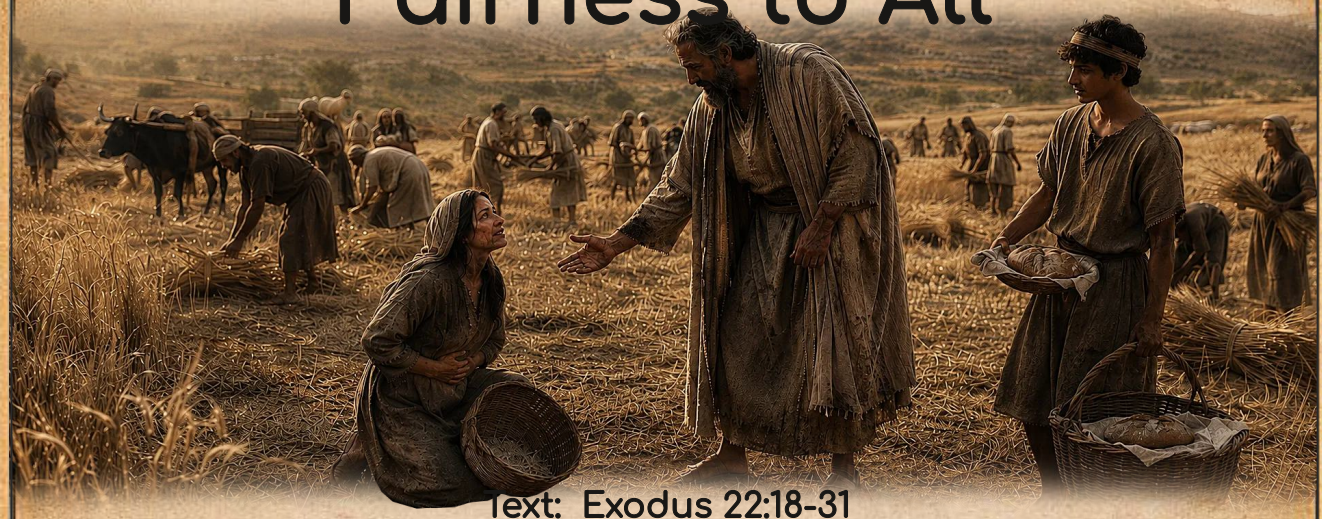
Exodus 12-16

DAILY MANNA

dailymanna.app

Tuesday. July 21, 2026

Fairness to All



Text: Exodus 22:18-31

KEY VERSE

"Thou shalt neither vex a stranger, nor oppress him.... Ye shall not afflict any widow, or fatherless child" (Exodus 22:21-22).

It was Horace Jackson Brown Jr., an American author, who counselled, "Live so that when your children think of fairness and integrity, they think of you." Unfortunately, not many people heed the advice. That is why there is so much injustice and inequity in this life. Those at the receiving end are mostly the poor and helpless ones. Most people care about nothing in this situation. But God is concerned about it. Godliness should make a difference here, for it implies fairness.

In today's text, the Lord outlines some precepts to guide His people from defilement and injustice. These defiling practices were common in Egypt, from where they had just been redeemed. First on the list is witchcraft, which from a divine perspective was viewed with utmost severity, so severe that it attracted capital punishment. Witchcraft, in this context, implied involvement in curious arts, a sin that amounted to gross blasphemy and had the potential of leading people away from dependence on God. Bestiality (a defilement common among the Egyptians) and idolatry also attracted capital punishment.

The laws regarding strangers, widows and fatherless children were humane. God wants fair treatment for all. These sets of people were particularly vulnerable. The Lord would not want anyone to take advantage of their weakness. He reminded Israel that they too were strangers in Egypt and, as such, should treat their strangers as they would have wanted to be treated by the Egyptians. He undertook to punish those who in any way oppress a widow or the fatherless. Similarly, the clothing of the poor used as a pledge must be returned to him before nightfall, as it served as a means of support for his life. Israel was also reminded to respect God-appointed leaders and their expected consecration of giving to God.

The essence of the foregoing injunctions is that the people of God would maintain a holy and undefiled life. God requires no less from us today. Godliness demands undivided devotion to God and due consideration for the feelings and needs of fellow human beings. Does your professed piety have accommodation for holiness towards God and fairness to others, especially the less privileged? The quiz is left for you to seriously ponder over.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

A profession of godliness without a human face is the height of ugliness.

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

Exodus 17-19

DAILY MANNA

dailymanna.app

Wednesday. July 22, 2026

Dawning Day of Restoration



Text: Joel 3:14-21

KEY VERSE

"And it shall come to pass in that day, that the mountains shall drop down new wine, and the hills shall flow with milk, and all the rivers of Judah shall flow with water, and a fountain shall come forth of the house of the LORD, and shall water the valley of Shittim" (Joel 3:18)

It was in Alfred Tennyson's poem, The Lotos-Eaters, that the following picture of hope is captured: "Courage!" he said, and pointed toward the land. "This mounting wave will roll us shoreward soon. In the afternoon they came unto a land, in which it seemed always afternoon. All around the coast the languid air did swoon, Breathing like one that hath a weary dream." The sea-wearied mariners finally found the shore of solace, where they excitedly burst into a joyful chorus: "Our island home is far beyond the wave; We will no longer roam." A day of hope and restoration awaits the Israel of God after the Lord has dealt with their Gentile enemies. Prophet Joel saw in his vision hordes of God's enemies rushing headlong and mindlessly into the 'valley of God's decisive judgment.'

A day of divine recompense is yet in the womb of time. Israel should be assured of God's unfailing day of their full restoration to the land promised to them by the Lord. Over many generations, their enemies had enslaved, deprived and vexed them with untempered bitterness. The Assyrians had ill-used them; the Egyptians had abused them; the Babylonians had traduced them; they had suffered untold hardship under the rule of the Medians and the Persians. The Greeks had not spared them too. The Romans had ruthlessly brutalised them and razed down Jerusalem finally in 70 AD.

However, "weeping may endure for a night, but joy cometh in the morning." These pains and pangs of many centuries under alien nations will soon be over, and a new dawn of peace, prosperity, and divine presence will be in the offing for Israel.

As it was for the enemies of Israel, so it shall be in the end for the enemies of the church of Christ. In contrast, the future is bright for those who have a cordial relationship with the Lord. People who trust Jesus Christ as their Saviour will never be called into God's judgment court, and they no longer need to fear the storm. Therefore, let the beloved of the Lord take heart and be patient in times of bitter trials, temptations and fierce persecutions. "Ye have condemned and killed the just; and he doth not resist you. Be patient therefore, brethren, unto the coming of the Lord. Behold, the husbandman waiteth for the precious fruit of the earth, and hath long patience for it, until he receive the early and the latter rain. Be ye also patient; stablish your hearts: for the coming of the Lord draweth nigh." Like the chorus of the Lotos-Eaters, these mounting waves of trials and temptation shall roll us eventually to the shore of rest! .

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

Every adversity confronting God's people bears an expiry date.

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

Exodus 20-22

DAILY MANNA

dailymanna.app

Thursday. July 23, 2026

Costly Consecration



Text: Genesis 22:1-11

KEY VERSE

"And he said, Take now thy son, thine only son Isaac, whom thou lovest, and get thee into the land of Moriah; and offer him there for a burnt offering upon one of the mountains which I will tell thee of" (Genesis 22:2).

Frederick Brotherton Meyer, a Baptist pastor and evangelist in England, contemporary and friend of D. L. Moody, observed that "Consecration is only possible when we give up our will about EVERYTHING." This may explain why most professing Christians shy away from true consecration. For some others, consecration should be moderated in such a manner as not to exceed the boundary set by "common sense".

Abraham, as seen in today's text, demonstrated a high level of consecration. To a normal person, God's command to him to offer his son, Isaac, as a sacrifice to Him was an invitation to eternal sorrow. But Abraham's love for and devotion to God were more than skin deep. It was such a commitment that was not hinged on any material benefit. The Lord's demand was explicit: "Take now thy son, thine only son Isaac, whom thou lovest... and offer him there for a burnt offering upon one of the mountains which I will tell thee of..." Isaac was an only son whose name meant laughter, a child of promise and therefore very beloved to his parents. Yet Abraham was willing to sacrifice him to God.

By that act, Abraham's obedience and faith were only being put to the test. He was willing to part with his highest love and hope on earth... to even go on a three-day journey to obey God's extraordinary command. He was moved neither by Isaac's affecting remark nor the thought of how others would react to him. Satisfied that Abraham's devotion to Him was no half measure, God intervened and prevented him from sacrificing Isaac. A lamb was divinely provided in his stead, a pointer to the Lord Jesus Christ, the "Lamb of God, which taketh away the sin of the world".

As you reflect on all these, consider how you will fare in God's test of obedience and faith. If the Lord today requires your Isaac – whatever constitutes your greatest joy on earth – will you be willing to part with it for God's sake? How much do you love God? Do social and material pursuits stand between you and God? Are you willing to place your prestige on the altar for the Lord? The test is ongoing. Will you pass it?

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

Our commitment to the Lord is determined by how far we are willing to go with Him.

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

Exodus 23-25

DAILY MANNA

dailymanna.app

Friday. July 24, 2026

Don't Be A Collateral Victim



Text: Joshua 12:1-6

KEY VERSE

"Now these are the kings of the land, which the children of Israel smote, and possessed their land on the other side Jordan toward the rising of the sun, from the river Arnon unto mount Hermon, and all the plain on the east" (Joshua 12:1).

There are people who sleep walk into disaster, through either arrogance, pride or sheer hubris. It may be that they had recorded successes in previous battles, or have become famous for their accomplishments. They may deem themselves to be invincible, and either declare a war that's totally unnecessary, or inject themselves into other people's battles. In the end, they become the victims of their ego and exaggerated sense of power and importance.

This is what happened to the kings of the nations on the east of River Jordan. The children of Israel were on a journey ordered by the Almighty God. They were heading to the land of Canaan, in fulfilment of the promise God made to Abraham, Isaac and Jacob. Their land was not part of Canaan, and therefore, was not intended to be inherited by the Israelites. The inheritance of the Israelites was to be solely Canaan, the land flowing with milk and honey. But on their way, the Israelites encountered nations that had heard about the supernatural work of God in bringing them out of Egypt. Although The Israelites did not declare war against them, these nations, some out of unfounded fear of losing their territory, and others out of envy and hatred against this nation that had a God that can subdue, humble and defeat Egypt, the great world power of the time, took it on themselves to stop Israel from progressing towards their land of promise. One of such kings was Sihon, king of the Amorites, whose nation was mainly a lush vegetation sandwiched by rivers and plain land that was a haven for pastoralists and for other forms of agriculture. The other king was Og, king of Bashan, a land of the remnants of the giants, with similar topography as the land of the Amorites. When they rose against the Israelites, they were roundly defeated, their kingdoms destroyed and their land confiscated by Moses. He subsequently allocated the land to two and half tribes of Israel, which desired to settle there because it was suitable for their vocation as pastoralists. Had those nations stayed out of the way of the Israelites, they would have remained in their land.

We must be wise and not take on battles that are not ours, whether out of sympathy with other people or to prove that we are powerful. As believers, we have more than enough battle against principalities and powers, rulers of the darkness of this world, spiritual wickedness in high places, against sin and Satan. The armour Christ has given us is intended to defeat these adversaries. It is not to be wasted in self-imposed battles that do not benefit the kingdom of God. Those who engage in the wrong battles suffer great loss, and live to regret it for the rest of their lives. Let us focus on the assignment Christ has given us, namely, taking the gospel to the world of sinners, and endeavouring to bring as many as are willing, into the kingdom of God.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

Those who fight battles without profit, reap rewards without benefits.

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

Exodus 26-29

DAILY MANNA

dailymanna.app

Saturday. July 25, 2026

God's Unchangeable Standard



Text: Matthew 19:1-12

KEY VERSE

"And I say unto you, Whosoever shall put away his wife, except it be for fornication, and shall marry another, committeth adultery: and whoso marrieth her which is put away doth commit adultery" (Matthew 19:9)

More and more people seem to forget Henry Ford's wise advice when asked on his 50th wedding anniversary for his rule for marital bliss and longevity. He replied: "Just the same as in the automobile business, stick to one model."

From our text, Christ's teaching about divorce and remarriage is explicit. Moses gave permission for divorce, not because it was so from the beginning but due to the people's hardness of heart. Jesus insisted that in the sight of God, marriage is a lifetime relationship that should never be severed by human action. God hates divorce (Malachi 2:16). His perfect will is the preservation of future generations and society through lasting marriages. God will give anyone great help in sustaining a marriage relationship or reconcilling estranged marriage partners. Christ's exception for 'fornication' in our text covers unfaithfulness before the actual marriage is contracted.

The experiences of couples who went through divorce are not encouraging. A study of divorced couples with preschool children shows that after a year of divorce, 60% of men and 73% of women feel they made a mistake and should have tried harder to make their marriage work. People have no idea how much anguish and stress is caused by divorce. This is a lesson to our godly fathers and mothers. They must ensure their children marry in the Lord. Friendship with ungodly families is like sowing the seeds of corruption in your own family. This unholy union of our sons and daughters with unbelieving spouses has introduced corruption in our families and churches.

Our role models are not the pop singers, film stars and fashion models who seem to change marriage partners like they change their robes. People may hold whatever views they want on divorce, but God, who is the Judge of the whole world has already spoken His mind in Scriptures. God's standard on marriage remains unchangeable even in this changeable world. Allow love and forgiveness to reign in your home.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

In the divine charter, there is no provision for divorce.

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

Exodus 30-32

DAILY MANNA

dailymanna.app

Sunday. July 26, 2026

Flee from Headwinds



Text: Jonah 2:1-10

KEY VERSE

"Then Jonah prayed unto the LORD his God out of the fish's belly" (Jonah 2:1).

Sometimes, people wait until they are buffeted by severe suffering, when it appears as if all hope is lost, when their human efforts have failed, before seeking God. They miss the crucial turning point, unlike David who cried out to God: "early will I seek thee... my soul thirsteth for thee, my flesh longeth for thee." How wise it is for people to turn to the Lord early, for then they are able to prevent the experiences that leave them bruised all through life, as happened to Jonah.

Jonah's suffering was avoidable. He was sent by God to take the message of salvation to Nineveh, but instead of obeying, he consciously rebelled against God. He bought a ticket and boarded a ship heading in the wrong direction. He thought he could outwit God. But there is no hiding place from God. He trailed Jonah in his escape ship with a tempest, and when he was about to be thrown into the sea, God prepared a whale to swallow him. This is in itself an act of mercy, for it is physically impossible to be in the belly of the whale for three days without dying. It means that God allowed Jonah to sink to the depth of hopelessness in the valley of the shadow of death, and yet granted him the grace to consciously bow at last, to His demands.

Deep in the belly of the fish, Jonah at last, cried out for mercy from God. He was mortified at the prospect of drowning at sea, and being eternally separated from God. He remembered God, and began to plead passionately to Him for another chance at life. He admitted that he had forsaken his only source of mercy. Now repentant, Jonah pledged his loyalty to God, and promised to redeem his vows, which presumably, included going anywhere the Lord sent him. Expectedly, God graciously extended His salvation to him, and commanded the whale to vomit out Jonah.

You must avoid being the architect of your misfortune, and flee from the temptation to reject God's word. You do not need to go through near-death experiences before retracing your steps from rebellion and disobedience. Where you have strayed from God's leading and guidance, and have erected your own devices, or excused your moral failures and weakness in character, you must seek God's mercy, asking for grace to follow Him faithfully, serve Him diligently and obey Him completely. Once He sees your sincerity of purpose, He will pardon and bring you back to His perfect will.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

In the divine charter, there is no provision for divorce.

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

Exodus 30-32

DAILY MANNA

dailymanna.app

Monday. July 27, 2026

It Is Their Time



Text: Jonah 2:1-10

KEY VERSE

"When I was daily with you in the temple, ye stretched forth no hands against me: but this is your hour, and the power of darkness" (Luke 22:53).

The story was told of a university town, where a feared cult leader ran a gang. The gang terrorised students, extorting, bullying, and even injuring others. He was regarded as "untouchable," and his group gained influence - notoriety. He lived large, dressed in designer clothes, and drove expensive cars. However, following a violent incident on campus that involved his group, a major investigation was launched by the authorities. The cult leader was arrested and expelled. His supporters disbanded and fled. Years later, while the students he terrorised built careers, he remained jobless, shunned, and miserable.

The cult leader had his time. So did the chief priests, captains of the temple, and elders who came to arrest and humiliate Jesus Christ. He told them, "...this is your hour, and the power of darkness." As these malicious zealots exuded the euphoria of their "exploit" of capturing Jesus, as if He were a robber, He queried them, "Be ye come out, as against a thief, with swords and staves?" Their rude attitude was unnecessary and a mismatch with Christ's peaceful disposition. They lacked the authority and courage to accost Christ all the time He ministered in the temple and everywhere; but why now? Christ could only rationalise their behaviour and reconcile Himself to it, considering it was their time. It was a time when the power of darkness was permitted to do its worst, which would eventually redound to God's purpose – and to humanity's redemption.

We often witness the "triumphing of the wicked," where dubious individuals exploit the political space, misuse power, and afflict the righteous. We find people "prospering" in business by cutting corners and through corruption. People gain fame and fortune by adopting perverted lifestyles and performances. We live in a time when evil is called good, and good evil – all to the frustration of the righteous. There is even a rise in the active persecution of Christians around the world. But we should be comforted by the submission of our Lord: it is their time. Consider also that "the triumphing of the wicked is short..." (Job 20:5).

If you are a true follower of Christ, keep walking with Him. Do not be dismayed by the attitudes and actions of the worldly. The temporary humiliation of Christ resulted in eternal honour and our redemption. Our present frustrations will soon result in permanent favour.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

Believer, benchmark not with unbelievers – they're in a different race.

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

Exodus 37-38

DAILY MANNA

dailymanna.app

Tuesday. July 28, 2026

A Burning Judgment



Text: Jonah 2:1-10

KEY VERSE

"And the mountains shall be molten under him, and the valleys shall be cleft, as wax before the fire, and as the waters that are poured down a steep place" (Micah 1:4).

For as long as anyone can remember, Mount Wingen in Australia has been burning, with an acrid smell of sulphur in the fumes issuing from cracks along its summit. Australia's Aboriginal inhabitants had known about this burning mountain for many years before the European settlers reached the area. But soon after they came, this spectacle attracted scientific attention. It was initially thought to be a volcano or pseudo-volcano. But Burning Mountain is not a volcano, Australia being fortunate in not having any volcanoes still active today. Instead, it was discovered that within Mt Wingen is a layer of coal that is burning, having been set alight by natural means.

Like this Australian burning mountain, the Lord promised to turn the high places upon the earth into a burning mountain, in a planned blistering judgment, delivered through Prophet Micah. Micah was chosen as a mouthpiece of the Lord, to condemn the sins of the children of Israel in his day. He predicted swift judgment that will ignite the mountains of the land with fire, which will cascade dangerously into the valleys, like a waterfall. Samaria, which at one time was the capital city of the corrupt northern kingdom of Israel, will be ploughed like the fields and the graven images, representing the idolatry of the people shall be burned with fire. Worthy of note here is God's promise to sustain these judgements until Israel repents.

Micah, like many other prophets in the Bible, was largely ignored by the sinning Israelites. Israel's protracted stubbornness dates back to their days in Egypt. When eventually, they were rescued from slavery through the supernatural hands of Jehovah, they refused to show appreciable gratitude. Interestingly, the messages of the various prophets sent to them from the onset struck a similar chord. They warned about impending judgment for Israel's sins. It is amazing that Israel could ignore prophets after prophets delivering the same messages until the predicted punishment occurred. Even their long stay in captivity in Babylon did not produce a consistent fruit of repentance in them.

God expects sinners to repent and turn to Him immediately after hearing the gospel. It is sheer foolishness to engage in the habit condemned in today's text. Sinners must be persuaded and compelled, though in love, to turn decisively from sin and obtain God's free salvation. Those who blatantly refuse this offer of redemption after repeated admonitions are doomed to face His fiery judgment in eternity.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

It is neither bravery nor wisdom, but self-destruct to remain adamant to God's warnings.

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

Exodus 39-40

DAILY MANNA

dailymanna.app

Wednessday. July 29, 2026

Christianity's All-Time Impact



Text: James 2:1-9

KEY VERSE

"But if ye have respect to persons, ye commit sin, and are convinced of the law as transgressors" (James 2:9).

Christianity and its adherents have indisputably been described as humanity's revolutionary "pioneers for legal equality". In his seminal study, Real Faith, the American evangelist, Mark Driscoll, writes: "Christians broke ground on the battle for... equality... The Bible from beginning to end describes God's heart for the poor and commands His people to be generous (and respectful) toward those who possess little or nothing...Christianity does not allow us to equate net worth with self-worth."

Apostle James' inspired dictum on how not to treat the underclass in the Church or society is but a slice of the unequivocal stand of Christ on the matter. As He walked the streets during His ministry, the Lord never contemned the poor or wretched sinner because of their socioeconomic status. He was (still is) their Friend. He brought down all class distinctions and taught His disciples that His Father's love extends to all humanity, beyond Jewry, religion or politics.

Great changes, movements and reforms over the generations along with the emergence of landmark constitutions such as that of the United States in 1787, have a heavy and unmistakable infusion of the teachings of Christianity on the equality of all men and women. This attests to the inerrant position of our Lord that He brought a message meant to transform lives for a rancour-free relationship among men, and prepare us for a hereafter of harmonious experience. The Lord does not expect Christians to wear a partisan or condescending outlook in our assembly or outside it.

Christianity has given the world a "royal law" that disavows looking down on the deprived in order to please the rich. James says those who flout such a creed that has benefited humanity are "transgressors". We do not only need to embrace the law wholeheartedly in the home and in our congregations, we also need to practise it in our workplaces. We must be doers of the Word.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

The ripple effects of the advent of Christ are ageless.

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

Ephesians 1-3

DAILY MANNA

dailymanna.app

Thursday. July 29, 2026

Glorious Restoration



Text: Jerimiah 50:17-24

KEY VERSE

"And I will bring Israel again to his habitation, and he shall feed on Carmel and Bashan, and his soul shall be satisfied upon mount Ephraim and Gilead" (Jeremiah 50:19).

The story of Jeff, as published on the website of Changed Lives Archives, narrates the amazing account of redemption and restoration of a wandering child come home. He grew up in the church and drifted away from the faith after the sudden death of his father. He pursued a career in rock music, which led him into broken relationships and addiction. However, through the persistent prayers and support of his aunt, Jeff experienced a spiritual revival. He surrendered his life to Christ. The good news and God's intervention must have accelerated his mother's miraculous healing and recovery from cancer.

Stepping back into history, the children of Israel had been warned by God to ensure faithful obedience to His laws and complete separation from the contamination of the Gentile nations around them, as they were preparing to inherit the Promised Land. Unfortunately, they kept on disobeying God, and falling into rebellion and idolatry. Eventually, God expressed his divine displeasure after they had exhausted his long rope of love and overdrawn their cheque of mercy. Prophet Jeremiah warned them of the consequences of their disobedience to God and stiff-necked refusal to change their ways and return to the path of righteousness.

The pronouncement of judgment eventually took its proper cause, and they went into captivity and suffered terribly in Babylon. The passage today, however, comes with a message of hope and comfort to the people of God. After the expiration of the period of their punishment, Jeremiah returned with a message of glorious restoration, refreshment and satisfaction in their land. Israel would have a second chance, after spending 70 years in exile.

This teaches us that no matter how far anyone has wandered away from God, the loving arms of the Lord are wide open to receive such if only the individual will retrace their steps like the prodigal son and return to God, the Father of mercy. Our loving Father in heaven is longing to receive as many as will seek His face. A new season of glorious restoration and refreshing starts now.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY
The door of restoration opens the moment a lost soul repents.

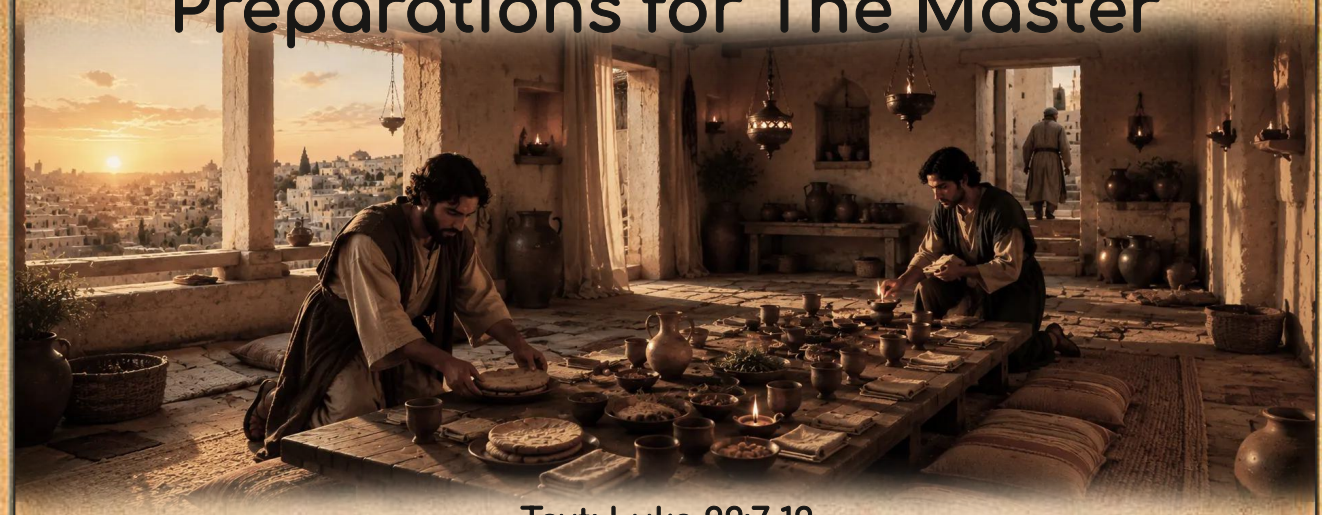
BIBLE IN ONE YEAR
Ephesians 4-6

DAILY MANNA

dailymanna.app

Friday. July 31, 2026

Preparations for The Master



Text: Luke 22:7-12

KEY VERSE

"And he sent Peter and John, saying, Go and prepare us the passover, that we may eat" (Luke 22:8).

One of the most enduring and longest placed dining tables in the world is in the Taj Falaknuma Palace in Hyderabad, India. The palace was built by Nawab Viqar-ul-Umra, and it was completed in 1894. The dining table was crafted with the finest materials available at that time. It is 108-foot-long and is designed to seat 101 guests. The table is part of the furniture still used today at the Taj Falaknuma Palace, which has been converted to a luxury hotel. It takes an uncommon table to entertain uncommon guests.

It was Passover time and for Jesus, it would be His last with His disciples. He wanted to celebrate it in an uncommon way. He instructed them to go and prepare a place for the feast, though, unknown to them, He had by divine power, already put arrangements in place. Getting the work done well will take their willingness, faith in His word and implicit obedience to His instructions for them to make a success of their assignment. Jesus sent Peter and John on this special assignment and wonderfully enough, on this occasion, Peter did not ask questions. He went as instructed and found the words of Jesus true to the letter.

There is nothing on earth that can take our Lord by surprise. John says Jesus "needed not that any should testify of man: for he knew what was in man" (John 2:25). He knew the houses and spaces available for Him. He knew the locations and available "large rooms" furnished to receive Him. But He did not take chances by keeping the guests wondering when he would come. He sent an advance party to get all things ready.

The Lord Jesus is coming back again and He wants you to be ready for the marriage supper of the Lamb. He has gone to prepare a place for the elect and He wants us to be watchful and prepared for the glorious occasion. Peter and John did not hesitate to carry out His plan to get the table for the feast ready. He has great expectations that you will carry out His instructions. Will you let Him down?

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

The Christian that fails to prepare for the coming glory will have a sad story.

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

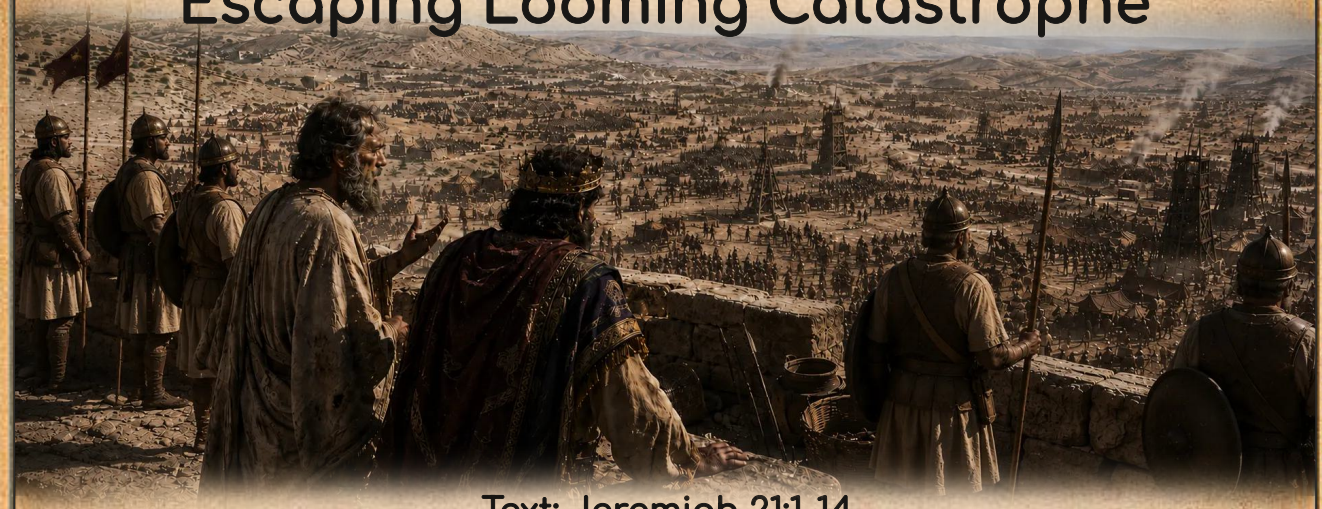
Philippians 1-4

DAILY MANNA

dailymanna.app

Saturday. August 1, 2026

Escaping Looming Catastrophe



Text: Jeremiah 21:1-14

KEY VERSE

"Thus saith the LORD God of Israel; Behold, I will turn back the weapons of war that are in your hands, wherewith ye fight against the king of Babylon, and against the Chaldeans, which besiege you... And I myself will fight against you with an outstretched hand and with a strong arm, even in anger, and in fury, and in great wrath" (Jeremiah 21:4,5).

What would make a loving father to give up on his biological son?

Zedekiah was the reigning king when Jerusalem fell to the Babylonians. He had tried to overrun the invading army of Babylon but his attempt was not approved by God. When the people sought divine help, Jeremiah made it clear to Zedekiah the king, "Thus saith the Lord God of Israel, Behold I will turn back the weapons of war that are in your hands wherewith ye fight the king of Babylon." In other words, God's answer was an emphatic 'no'. Consequently, the two sons of Zedekiah were slaughtered before his eyes by the Babylonians. His own eyes were blinded and in painful humiliation, he was led away in chains to Babylon where he died later in exile.

The underlying spiritual cause of the fall of Judah and Jerusalem was not so much due to the superior military might of Babylon as to the effect of God's decree against the people because of Manasseh's sin and Judah's apostasy. God never excuses unconfessed sin. He Judges and punishes it. There are those with the misguided mind-set that God winks at sin and that grace covers all acts of impropriety. How catastrophically wrong such warped souls are. You can't ride rough shod over His Son's painful death on the cross and expect a soft-glove treatment.

Those who repeatedly reject God's clear reproof and warning, who despise His chastening and correction, run the inevitable risk of excluding themselves from His grace. There is no more plea for mercy when once God's grace is abused and rejected. God's love must not be taken for granted. This dispensation of grace does not give license for carelessness and recalcitrant behaviour.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY
Kings and rulers are not to take God's grace for granted.

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR
John 1-3

DAILY MANNA

dailymanna.app

Wednesday. August 5, 2026

Defilement Detested



Text: Leviticus 11:13-28

KEY VERSE

"And he that beareth the carcass of them shall wash his clothes, and be unclean until the even: they are unclean unto you" (Leviticus 11:28).

Leonard Syme, a professor of epidemiology at the University of California at Berkeley, indicates the importance of social ties and social support systems in relationship to mortality and disease rates. He simply underscores the saying that attack is the best defence. Defiant posture to defilements regardless the form or the size is the panacea to living holy.

This is the gem in the seemingly extensive and meticulous dietary regulation outlined in our passage, which serves a crucial purpose beyond maintaining physical health. To the Israelites, it was a constant reminder to their distinct identity and calling on one hand and a perpetual prompt to seek holiness and live in constant obedience to God in all aspects of life on the other hand. In the same way, believers today are called to maintain a distinct identity in the world. Our lives must be marked by holiness, obedience, and respect for God's commandments.

Our text, on the surface, sets forth the dietary restrictions on fowls or birds (Leviticus 11:13b-19) and flying insects (Leviticus 11:19-23), but at a deeper level they are part of a larger tapestry of holiness and obedience to God's laws.

The hallmark of this dietary law is the indelible imprint of God's work in them and the call to live lives directed by God. The regulation constantly reminds the Israelites that they are a different and separate people who should by no means live the same way or share common values with the surrounding nations. As the distinction exists between clean and unclean animals, birds or creeping creatures so is there an uncompromisable difference between the Israel of God and other nations. Their food choices reflect this consecrated, holy identity.

How this speaks to you, the "ecclesia", called out one today. If you are saved, your only option is to be separated to live holily before the Lord Who saved you: "But just as He who called you is holy, so be holy in all you do; for it is written: "But as he which hath called you is holy, so be ye holy in all manner of conversation; Because it is written, Be ye holy; for I am holy" (1 Peter 1:15,16). These detailed and seemingly complicated instructions underscore the place of God's amazing grace and the unmerited favour He shows to us by His covenant loving-kindness.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

Passion for heaven necessitates strict separation and unqualified obedience to the word.

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

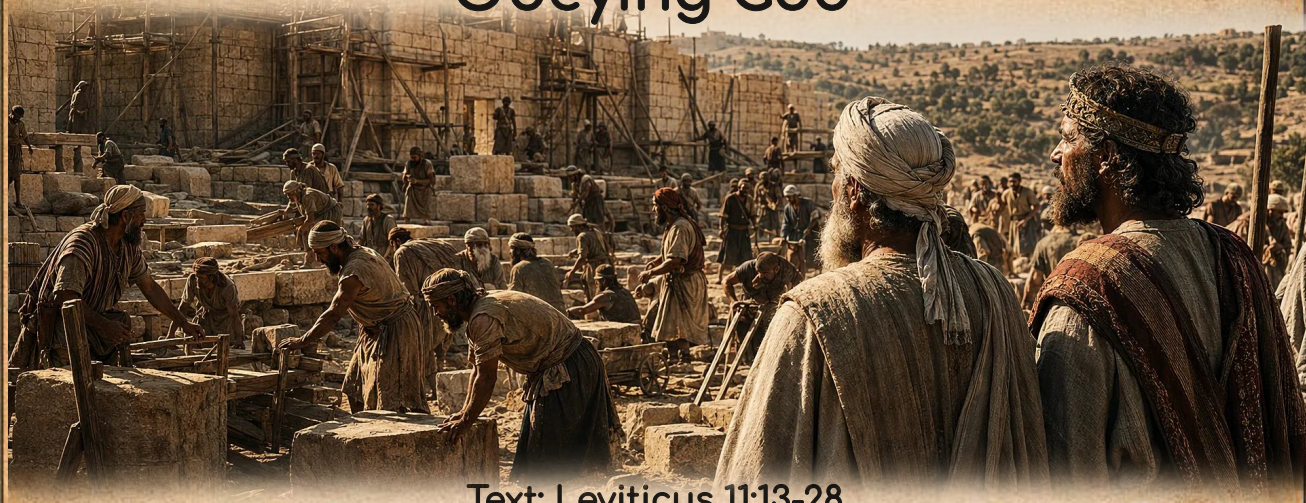
John 10-12

DAILY MANNA

dailymanna.app

Thursday. August 6, 2026

Obeying God



Text: Leviticus 11:13-28

KEY VERSE

"Then Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, and Joshua the son of Josedech, the high priest, with all the remnant of the people, obeyed the voice of the LORD their God, and the words of Haggai the prophet, as the LORD their God had sent him, and the people did fear before the LORD" (Haggai 1:12).

Bede Griffiths, a British Catholic priest, dramatically defined obedience in a way that best explains why the returning offspring of Abraham began to enjoy the withheld blessings of Jehovah after hearkening to His charge. Griffiths said pithily, "Obedience is detachment from the self. An elastic meaning of the priest's statement is that when you obey an order, you are deliberately freeing yourself from your own opinion, reason, will, intention, and deciding to go the way of the order."

That was exactly what the homecoming exiles from captivity did as they set their feet on their beloved Jerusalem. The Lord had asked them through His servants to rehabilitate His temple. But they were interested in fixing their dilapidated houses first. They did not detach themselves from their will and way. That amounted to alienation from God. Therefore, they were denied His blessings. But they repented and distanced themselves from their self-will and way. Thus, God restored fellowship with His people. He said, "I am with you." The people were blessed with the needed resources to do the assignment the Lord gave them when they obeyed Him.

Adam and Eve's disobedience in the Garden of Eden has brought disastrous and untold hardship upon man. Rejecting the way of God is still the bane of humanity. His laws on marriage are being disregarded. His word is misinterpreted by ministers to suit pecuniary pursuits. The Church is accommodating strange doctrines. However, those who take delight in disobeying God's word will incur His wrath except they repent.

However, Christ, the last Adam, has shown us the everlasting benefits of heeding the Father's instructions. "And being found in fashion as a man, he humbled himself, and became obedient unto death, even the death of the cross" (Philippians 2:8). Our Lord forsook His own will and comfort to die for our sins as desired by the Father. Now, He is highly exalted on the right hand side of God in heaven. To enjoy God's abiding presence and other promised blessings here and hereafter, obedience to God is necessary. Those who disobey Him risk losing His presence.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY
Our love for God is measured by the extent of our obedience to Him.

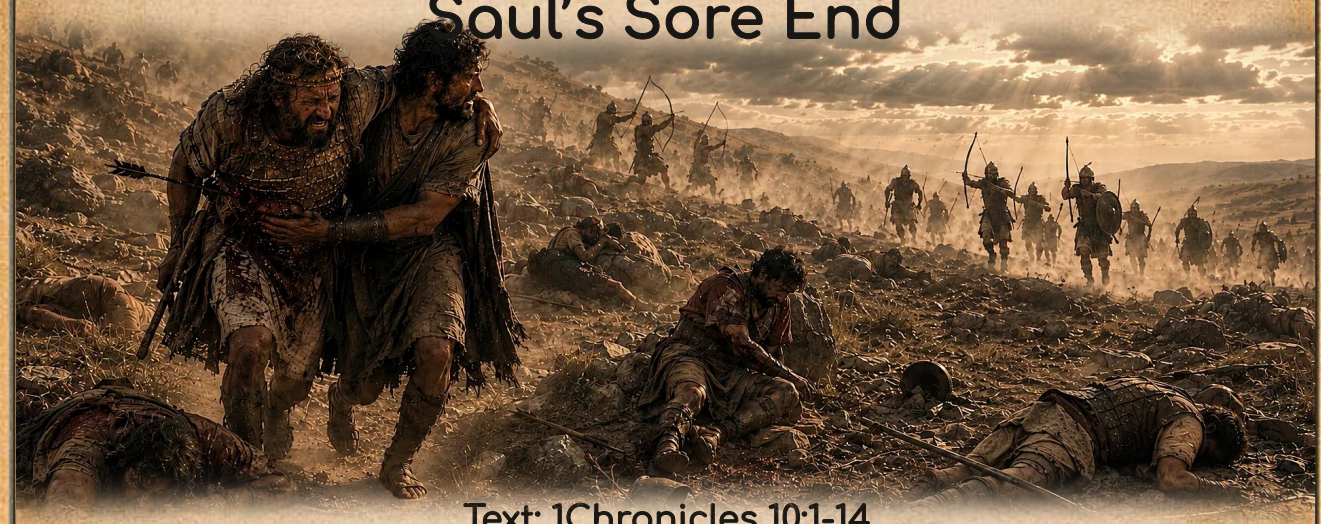
BIBLE IN ONE YEAR
John 13-15

DAILY MANNA

dailymanna.app

Thursday. August 7, 2026

Saul's Sore End



Text: 1Chronicles 10:1-14

KEY VERSE

"So Saul died for his transgression which he committed against the LORD, even against the word of the LORD, which he kept not, and also for asking counsel of one that had a familiar spirit, to enquire of it" (1 Chronicles 10:13).

An old adage says, "It's the end that counts, not the beginning or what's in between". The storyteller may garnish the opening and the intervening passages with the most pungent and arresting language about the main character. Yet, if the narrative closes with the tragic end of the protagonist owing to his character flaws, he would draw little sympathy. The reader of his biography wants the principal personality to end with laurels the way he started.

Alas, Saul, Israel's first king, experienced a bitter conclusion, after a blazing and historic beginning. And he did not go down alone. He took along "his three sons, and all his house." The children of Israel who escaped death in the battle against the Philistines fled, allowing the enemy to take over their land. How did it all start? It began with the breach of God's express commandment. Saul disobeyed the Lord, and followed it up, not with repentance, but with more sinful conduct. Even at the point of death, he enacted the final iniquity: suicide.

It is not enough for nations and their institutions of administration to seek leaders to guide them. They must look for pivotal men and women who would wholly yield themselves to the shepherding and correction of God. This is key if they want a society that would thrive, prosper and withstand challenges and upheavals of statehood. Now, this requirement holds true also in the different aspects of the workforce of the church. Otherwise, their frailties would destroy them and those they are leading, as in the case of Saul.

Our Lord is the ultimate Leader. Without Him, man would be perennially on a bumpy ride, falling into a series of perilous failures. The Church should step in to halt the slide by teaching sound scriptural doctrines to raise God-fearing leaders. We must saturate everywhere with heaven-focused citizens with our preaching and righteous lifestyle. This is the only bulwark against the rise of "Sauls" whose untamed false start and godlessness would drive the entire land into the abyss.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY
When we have godly leaders, we are assured of God-fearing citizens.

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR
John 16-18

DAILY MANNA

dailymanna.app

Wednesday. August 19 2026

Enduring Reconciliation



Text: Genesis 33:5-15

KEY VERSE

"And he lifted up his eyes, and saw the women and the children; and said, Who are those with thee? And he said, The children which God hath graciously given thy servant" (Genesis 33:5).

After the horrific genocide in 1994, Rwanda focused heavily on national reconciliation. The Gacaca Courts, a system of community-based justice, allowed perpetrators of the genocide to confess their crimes and ask for forgiveness, while victims could voice their suffering. The emphasis on unity and a shared vision for rebuilding the country contributed to Rwanda's remarkable recovery and the avoidance of further ethnic conflict. Although there are ongoing challenges, the national narrative of "unity and reconciliation" has continued to play a central role in Rwanda's politics and society.

Jacob had lived for years under the shadow of a broken relationship with his brother, Esau. Their past was filled with deceit, betrayal, and conflict. Having stolen Esau's birth right and blessing, the resultant rift was so deep that Esau had vowed to kill Jacob. After years of separation, Jacob now had to face Esau, but with trepidation and fear of retribution. However, what ensued was a stunning picture of grace and a lasting reconciliation, with no record of relapse into hostilities.

Their reconciliation must have been mutual. That "... Esau ran to meet him, and embraced him, and fell on his neck, and kissed him: and they wept" showed his willingness to forgive Jacob and let go of his anger and bitterness, and the pain of the past - a rare display of grace. On the other hand, Jacob exemplifies a posture of humility. His bowing before Esau, offering gifts of homage, and acknowledging his wrongs demonstrate the humility required for true reconciliation.

We are called to the same grace and reconciliation that Jacob and Esau experienced. Perhaps there are areas where we need to humble ourselves and seek forgiveness. We are called to extend grace, even when the hurt is deep.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

Reconciliation draws the curtain on a dark past and opens a door for a bright future.

BIBLE IN ONE YEAR

Job 16-18